Campus Connect: AI-Driven Community & Study Coordination

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

I. Executive Summary

Campus Connect is a mobile-first platform designed to solve the fragmented communication and manual study group formation challenges faced by university students. By leveraging AI-driven matchmaking technology, the platform connects students with the right study partners based on their academic needs, learning preferences, and availability, while consolidating campus information into a single, accessible hub. The primary business goal is to achieve **40% student adoption within the first semester** while demonstrating measurable improvements in academic collaboration and reduced social isolation.

II. Target User & Persona

User Persona: Priya, the Overwhelmed Sophomore

Demographics:

- **Age:** 19 years old
- **Year:** Second-year Computer Science student
- **Location:** Lives in campus dormitory
- **Tech Proficiency:** High - uses 5+ apps daily

Background: Priya is a dedicated student juggling multiple courses with varying difficulty levels. She transferred from a different city and is still building her social network on campus. She's passionate about technology and active on Instagram, WhatsApp, and Discord but finds herself lost in the noise of 12+ group chats related to different courses, clubs, and social activities.

Motivations:

- Maintain a strong GPA (currently 3.6, aiming for 3.8+)
- Build meaningful academic relationships with peers who share similar study habits
- Stay informed about campus events and opportunities without constantly checking multiple platforms
- Find balance between academic excellence and social connections

Tech Habits:

- Checks phone 150+ times daily
- Primarily uses WhatsApp (8 hours/week), Instagram (6 hours/week), and Notion for personal organization
- Prefers quick, visual information over long emails
- Expects instant responses and real-time notifications
- Values apps with clean UI/UX and minimal learning curve

Communication/Study Pain Points:

1. **Information Overload:** Receives 200+ messages daily across multiple WhatsApp groups for different courses; important announcements get buried in casual chatter
2. **Study Group Formation Struggles:** Spent 3 weeks last semester trying to find the right Data Structures study group through random class announcements; ended up in a group with mismatched learning paces
3. **Missed Opportunities:** Discovered a valuable coding workshop only after it ended because the announcement was posted on a bulletin board she doesn't pass daily
4. **Time Wastage:** Spends 45+ minutes daily scrolling through irrelevant messages to find course-related information
5. **Social Isolation:** Despite being surrounded by hundreds of students, struggles to find study partners who match her dedication level and preferred study times (early mornings)
6. **Platform Fragmentation:** Switches between Telegram (CS club), WhatsApp (course groups), Discord (hackathon team), and university portal (official announcements) throughout the day

> "I just want to find people who are as serious about acing Algorithms as I am, without having to wade through hundreds of memes and random chats. Why isn't there a better way to connect with the right study partners?"

III. Solution Overview (MVP)

Minimum Viable Product Definition

The Campus Connect MVP focuses on **solving the core problem of AI-driven study group matchmaking** with minimal additional features to validate Problem-Solution Fit. The MVP will be a mobile application (iOS and Android) that enables students to create profiles, get matched with compatible study partners, and communicate within the app.

Core MVP Features

1. AI-Driven Study Group Matchmaker

The intelligent matching algorithm analyzes student profiles to create optimal study group pairings

2. Simple Student Profile

University SSO authentication with study preferences questionnaire

3. Basic In-App Messaging

One-on-one and group chat for matched study partners

4. Study Group Formation Flow

Accept/decline matches and create study groups

AI-Driven Study Group Matchmaker (Primary Feature)

Input Parameters:

- Course enrollment (primary matching criteria)
- Preferred study time (morning/afternoon/evening/late night)
- Learning pace (fast-paced/moderate/slow and steady)
- Study style preference (visual learner/auditory/kinesthetic/reading-writing)
- Academic goals (grade target: pass/B-grade/A-grade)
- Current understanding level of the subject (struggling/average/advanced)
- Preferred group size (2-3 people / 4-5 people / 6+ people)

Matching Algorithm Logic:

- **Priority 1:** Same course enrollment (mandatory match)
- **Priority 2:** Compatible study times (at least 60% overlap)
- **Priority 3:** Similar learning pace and current understanding level
- **Priority 4:** Aligned academic goals and study preferences

Output:

- Curated list of 5-8 potential study partners ranked by compatibility score (displayed as %)
- Brief compatibility summary for each match ("Great match! You both prefer morning study sessions and aim for A-grade")
- Option to send connection request to matched students

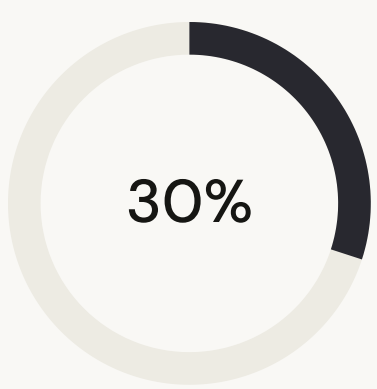
Features Explicitly Out of Scope for MVP

To maintain focus on validating the core matchmaking value proposition, the following features are **NOT** included in the MVP:

- Campus events aggregation or discovery
- Club/organization information
- Calendar integration
- File sharing or collaborative documents
- Video/audio calls
- Campus-wide social feed or news
- Tutor marketplace
- Study space booking
- Gamification or rewards
- Push notifications beyond critical matches
- Web version (mobile-only MVP)

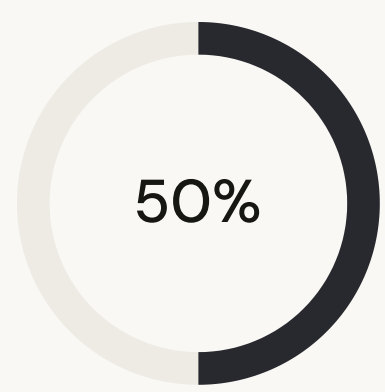
Success Validation Criteria

The MVP will be considered successful if:



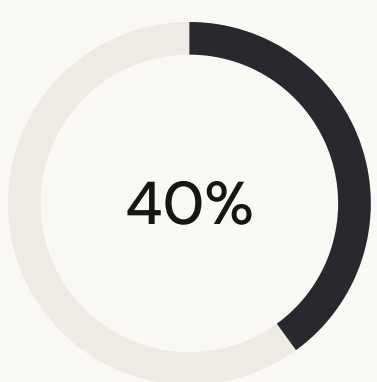
Connection Requests

Of matched users send at least one connection request



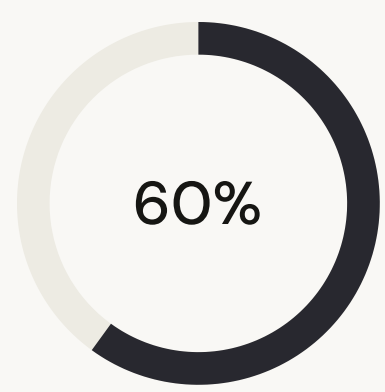
Request Acceptance

Of sent connection requests are accepted



Study Sessions

Of users who form groups schedule at least one study session

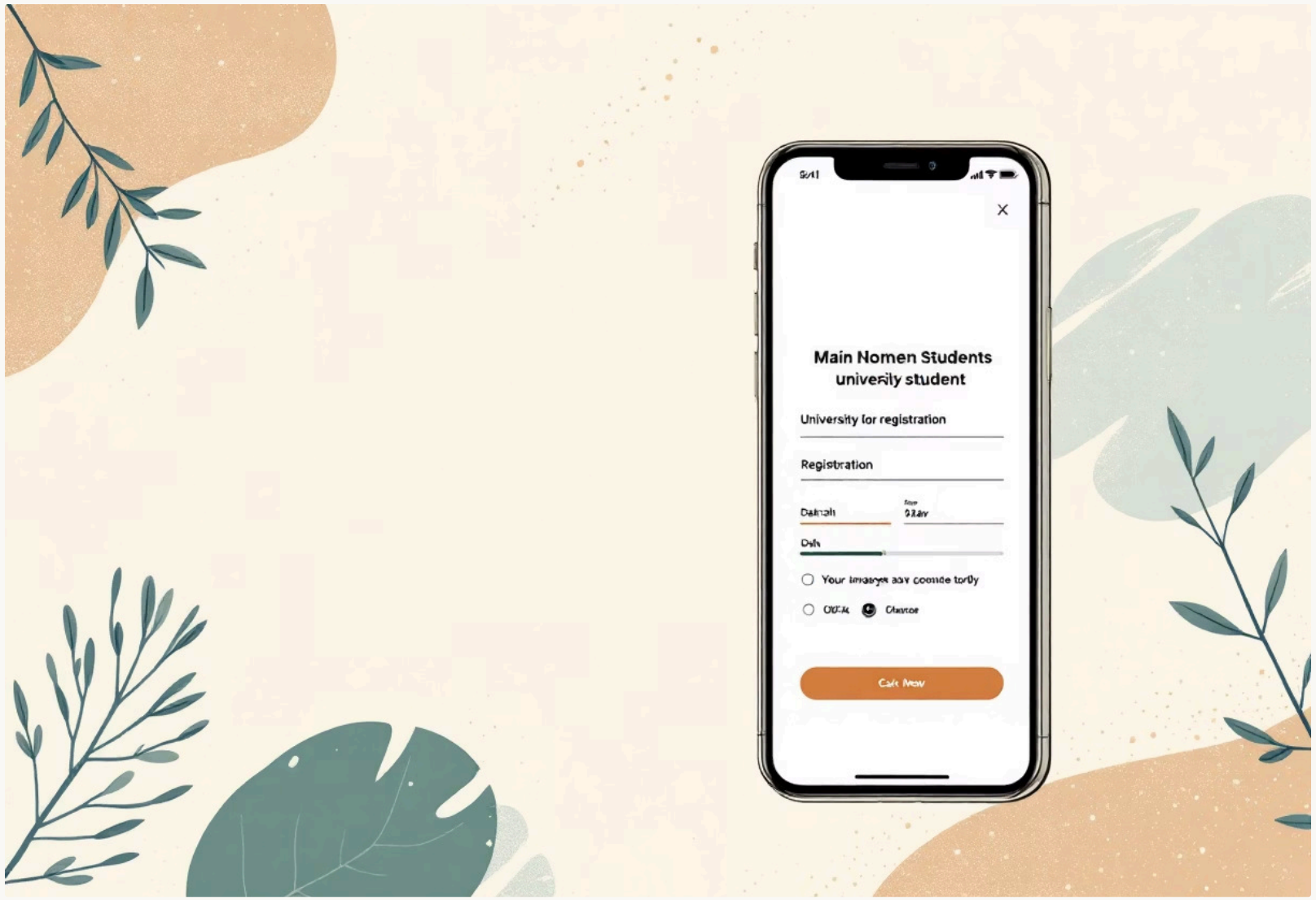


Match Quality

IV. User Stories & Acceptance Criteria

User Story 1: Profile Creation & Onboarding

> **As Priya,** I want to quickly create my profile using my university credentials and set my study preferences, **so that** I can start finding compatible study partners without wasting time on lengthy registration.



Acceptance Criteria:

01

User can authenticate via university SSO (Google/Microsoft) in under 30 seconds

02

Onboarding questionnaire contains exactly 7 questions and takes no more than 3 minutes to complete

03

User can skip profile photo upload and complete registration without it

04

System displays progress indicator (e.g., "Step 2 of 4") throughout onboarding

User Story 2: Receiving Personalized Match Recommendations

As Siya, I want to receive AI-generated study partner recommendations for my enrolled courses, **so that** I can connect with students who match my learning style and schedule without manually searching.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Upon completing profile setup, user receives match suggestions within 5 seconds
2. Match list displays 5-8 recommendations per enrolled course, ranked by compatibility percentage
3. Each match card shows: name, compatibility score, shared course, 2-3 matching attributes (e.g., "Both prefer early morning study")
4. User can filter matches by specific course if enrolled in multiple courses

User Story 3: Sending and Receiving Connection Requests

As Priyanka, I want to send connection requests to my recommended matches and receive requests from others, **so that** I can build my study network with compatible peers.

Send Request

One tap from match card

Add Message

Optional 200 character note

Get Notified

In-app notification received

Accept/Decline

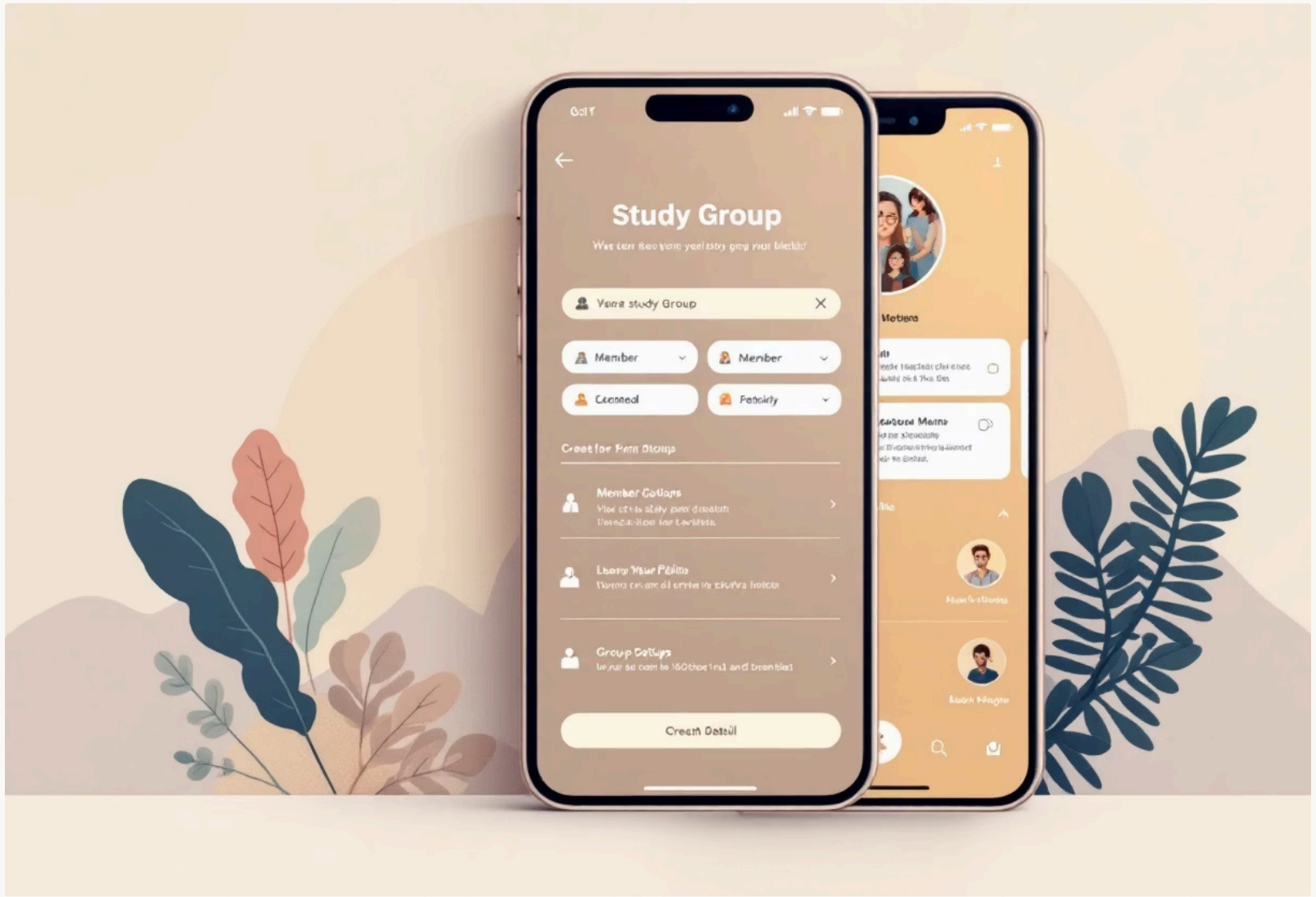
Review in Requests tab

Acceptance Criteria:

1. User can send a connection request with one tap from the match card
2. Optional personalized message field (max 200 characters) appears when sending request
3. User receives in-app notification when someone sends them a connection request
4. Pending requests are displayed in a dedicated "Requests" tab with Accept/Decline options

User Story 4: Forming a Study Group

> **As Parul,** I want to create a study group with my accepted connections, **so that** I can coordinate study sessions with multiple compatible partners in one place.



Acceptance Criteria:

- User can create a study group by selecting 2+ accepted connections from their network
- Group creation form includes: group name, primary course, preferred meeting time, study location (text field)
- All selected members receive instant group invitation notification
- Group appears in user's "My Groups" section immediately after creation
- User can create maximum 5 active groups to maintain focus

User Story 5: Communicating with Study Group Members

As Priyanshu, I want to message my study group members within the app, **so that** I can coordinate meeting times and discuss study topics without switching to another messaging platform.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. User can access group chat from the "My Groups" section with one tap
2. Messages are delivered in real-time (max 2-second delay)
3. Chat interface displays sender name, timestamp, and message content
4. User can see when message is sent/delivered with simple status indicator
5. Chat history is preserved and accessible when user returns to the conversation

User Story 6: Updating Study Preferences

As Priyal, I want to update my study preferences and course list mid-semester, **so that** my match recommendations remain relevant as my schedule and needs change.

Access Settings

User can access "Edit Profile" option from settings menu

Trigger Recalculation

Changes to study preferences trigger immediate match recalculation

Get Notification

System notifies user: "We've found new matches based on your updated preferences"

View New Matches

Updated match suggestions appear within 10 seconds of saving changes

Preserve Connections

Previous connections and groups remain unaffected by profile updates

User Story 7: Evaluating Match Quality

As Pakhi, I want to provide feedback on my matches after connecting with study partners, **so that** the AI algorithm can improve and future recommendations become more accurate.

Acceptance Criteria

01

Feedback Timing

After first study session (7 days after group formation), user receives optional feedback prompt

02

Feedback Components

Feedback form includes: match quality rating (1-5 stars), compatibility accuracy (Yes/No), brief optional comment

03

Quick Submission

Feedback can be submitted in under 30 seconds

04

Optional Participation

User can skip feedback without penalty or repeated prompts

05

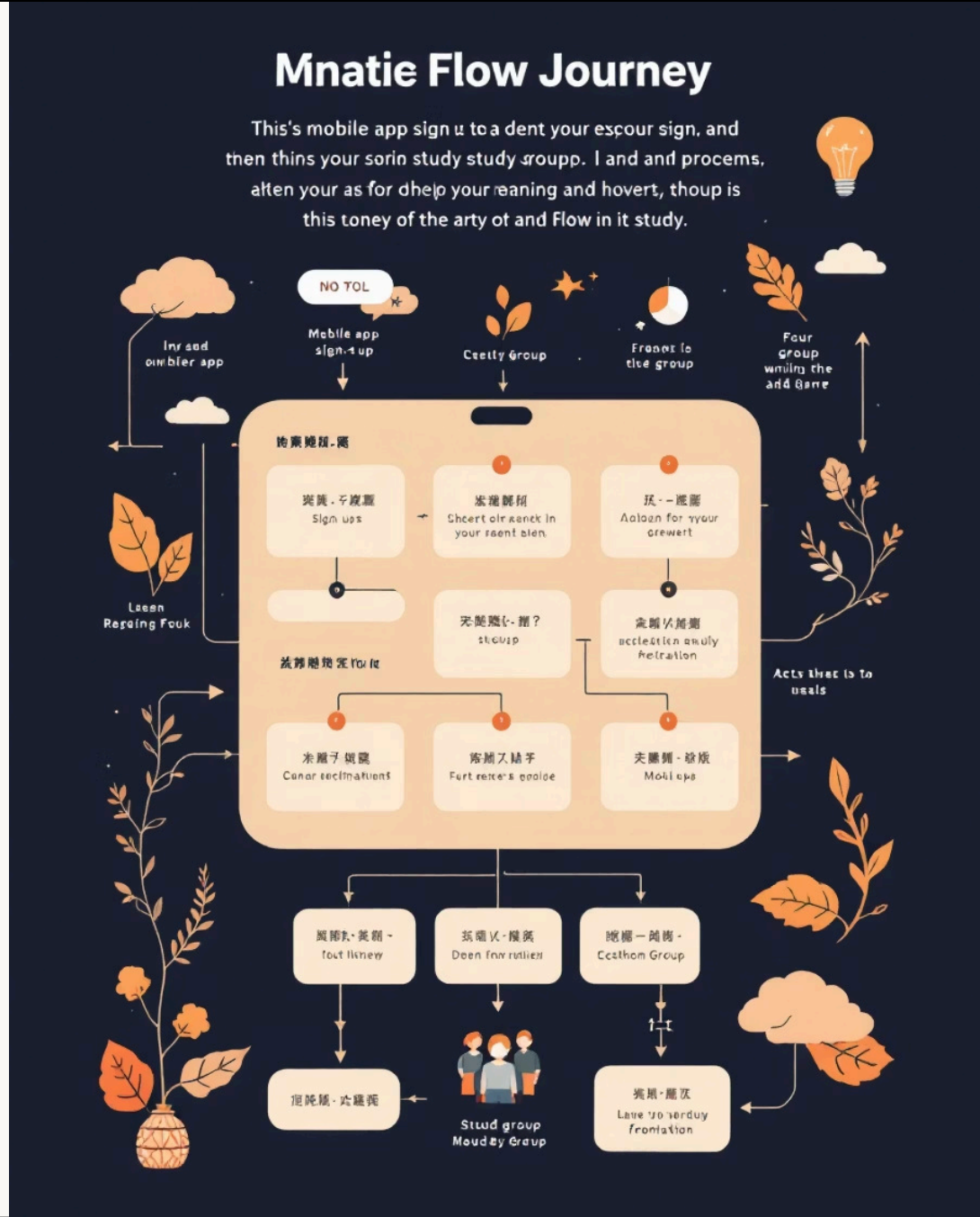
Algorithm Impact

Submitted feedback influences future match algorithm weights for that user

V. User Flow Diagram

Core MVP User Journey: From Sign-Up to Matched Study Group

A comprehensive step-by-step flow showing how new users authenticate, set up profiles, get matched with study partners, and form active study groups.



Complete User Journey Flow

The following diagram maps the entire user experience from initial app access through successful study group formation:

```
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│ START: New User Opens App │
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│
▼
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│ Step 1: AUTHENTICATION │
│ - Tap "Sign in with University Account" │
│ - Redirected to University SSO (Google/Microsoft) │
│ - Grant permissions & authenticate │
│ - Return to Campus Connect app │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
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┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│ Step 2: BASIC PROFILE SETUP │
│ - System auto-fills: Name, Email, Student ID │
│ - User selects: Major, Current Semester │
│ - Upload profile photo (optional - can skip) │
│ - Tap "Continue" │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
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│ Step 3: COURSE SELECTION │
│ - View current semester course catalog │
│ - Select enrolled courses (search or browse by department) │
│ - Minimum 1 course required, maximum 8 courses │
│ - Tap "Next" │
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┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│ Step 4: STUDY PREFERENCES QUESTIONNAIRE │
│ Question 1: What's your preferred study time? │
│ → Options: Early Morning / Late Morning / Afternoon / │
│ Evening / Late Night │
│ │
│ Question 2: How would you describe your learning pace? │
│ → Options: Fast-paced / Moderate / Slow and Steady │
│ │
│ Question 3: What's your study style? │
│ → Options: Visual / Auditory / Reading-Writing / │
│ Kinesthetic │
│ │
│ Question 4: What's your typical grade goal? │
│ → Options: Pass / B-grade / A-grade │
│ │
│ Question 5: Preferred study group size? │
│ → Options: 2-3 people / 4-5 people / 6+ people │
│ │
│ Question 6: Where do you prefer to study? │
│ → Options: Library / Café / Dorm / Online │
│ │
│ Question 7: How do you rate your current understanding? │
│ → Options: Struggling / Average / Advanced │
│ (Asked for each selected course separately) │
│ │
│ Progress indicator shows: "Step 4 of 5" │
│ - Tap "Submit Preferences" │
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│ Step 5: AI MATCHING PROCESS (Backend) │
│ - AI algorithm analyzes user profile & preferences │
│ - Scans database for students in same courses │
│ - Calculates compatibility scores based on: │
│ * Course overlap (mandatory) │
│ * Study time compatibility (weighted 30%) │
│ * Learning pace match (weighted 25%) │
│ * Academic goals alignment (weighted 20%) │
│ * Study style compatibility (weighted 15%) │
│ * Current understanding level (weighted 10%) │
│ - Generates ranked match list │
│ - Processing time: 3-5 seconds │
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│ Step 6: MATCH RECOMMENDATIONS DISPLAYED │
│ Home Screen shows: │
│ - Welcome message: "Hi Priya! We found 23 study partners" │
│ - Tabs for each enrolled course │
│ │
│ Match Card Display (per course): │
│ ┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐ │
│ │
```

System Architecture & Technology Stack

A. System Architecture

Platform: Mobile-first application (iOS and Android native apps)

Technology Stack:

- **Frontend:** React Native (cross-platform development)
- **Backend:** Node.js with Express.js framework
- **Database:** PostgreSQL (user profiles, courses, connections) + Redis (caching, real-time chat)
- **Cloud Infrastructure:** AWS (EC2 for compute, RDS for database, S3 for media storage)
- **Real-time Communication:** WebSocket (Socket.io) for instant messaging

B. AI Matching Component (Core Feature)

Algorithm Type: Hybrid matching system combining:

Content-based filtering	Collaborative filtering	Constraint satisfaction
User preferences and profile attributes	Learning from successful past matches	Hard filters like same course enrollment

AI Model Specifications

Input Data Points (per user):

```
{
  "user_id": "string",
  "courses": ["CS301", "CS405", "MATH210"],
  "study_preferences": {
    "preferred_time": "early_morning",
    "learning_pace": "fast_paced",
    "study_style": "visual",
    "grade_goal": "A_grade",
    "group_size_preference": "2-3",
    "study_location": "library",
    "current_level": {
      "CS301": "average",
      "CS405": "struggling",
      "MATH210": "advanced"
    }
  },
  "availability": {
    "monday": ["07:00-09:00", "18:00-20:00"],
    "tuesday": ["07:00-09:00"],
    "wednesday": ["07:00-09:00", "18:00-20:00"],
    ...
  }
}
```

Matching Algorithm Logic

Phase 1: Course Filtering

Query database for all users enrolled in the same course. Only proceed with users who share at least one course (Hard Constraint).

Phase 2: Compatibility Score

Calculate weighted compatibility score based on time match (30%), pace match (25%), goal match (20%), style match (15%), and level match (10%).

Phase 3: Ranking & Filtering

Sort matches by compatibility score (descending), filter out scores below 60%, and return top 5-8 matches per course.

Compatibility Score Calculation

Formula:

$$\text{Compatibility Score} = (\text{Time_Match} \times 0.30) + (\text{Pace_Match} \times 0.25) + (\text{Goal_Match} \times 0.20) + (\text{Style_Match} \times 0.15) + (\text{Level_Match} \times 0.10)$$

Where each match score is calculated as:

- **Time_Match:** Percentage of overlapping available time slots
- **Pace_Match:** 1.0 if exact match, 0.5 if one level difference, 0 if two levels
- **Goal_Match:** 1.0 if same goal, 0.7 if one level difference, 0.3 if two levels
- **Style_Match:** 1.0 if same style, 0.6 if compatible styles (visual-reading), 0.3 if different
- **Level_Match:** 1.0 if complementary (struggling-advanced), 0.8 if same level, 0.5 if two advanced

Output Format

```
{
  "course_id": "CS301",
  "matches": [
    {
      "user_id": "student_456",
      "name": "Sarah M.",
      "compatibility_score": 89,
      "matching_attributes": [
        "Both prefer early morning study",
        "Both aim for A-grade",
        "Similar learning pace"
      ],
      "profile_photo": "url_to_photo"
    },
    ...
  ]
}
```

Machine Learning Enhancement (Future Iteration): Collect feedback data on successful matches (users who form groups and meet regularly). Train supervised learning model to identify hidden compatibility patterns. Continuously improve weight distribution in scoring formula.

C. Third-Party Integrations

1. University Authentication API (SSO)

- **Purpose:** Secure student authentication and profile data retrieval
- **Integration Method:** OAuth 2.0 protocol
- **Data Retrieved:** Student name, email, student ID, enrolled courses, major, semester
- **Endpoint Example:** https://university-sso.edu/oauth/authorize
- **Security:** JWT tokens for session management

2. University Course Catalog API

- **Purpose:** Real-time course information and enrollment data
- **Data Required:** Course ID, course name, department, semester, enrolled student list
- **Update Frequency:** Synced daily during add/drop period, weekly during semester
- **Fallback:** Manual course entry if API unavailable

3. Push Notification Service

- **Platform:** Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM) for Android, Apple Push Notification Service (APNs) for iOS
- **Triggers:** Connection requests, message receipts, group invitations
- **Rate Limiting:** Maximum 5 notifications per user per day to avoid spam

D. Data Storage Requirements

Database Schema (Simplified):

Core Tables

- **Users Table:** user_id (primary key), name, email, student_id, major, semester, profile_photo_url, created_at
- **Courses Table:** course_id (primary key), course_name, department, semester
- **User_Courses (Junction Table):** user_id, course_id, current_level, enrollment_date
- **Study_Preferences Table:** user_id (foreign key), preferred_time, learning_pace, study_style, grade_goal, group_size_preference, location_preference

Interaction Tables

- **Matches Table (Cache):** match_id (primary key), user_id, matched_user_id, course_id, compatibility_score, created_at
- **Connections Table:** connection_id (primary key), requester_id, receiver_id, status (pending/accepted/declined), created_at
- **Study_Groups Table:** group_id (primary key), group_name, course_id, meeting_time, location, created_by, created_at
- **Group_Members (Junction Table):** group_id, user_id, joined_at
- **Messages Table:** message_id (primary key), sender_id, conversation_id, message_text, timestamp, delivery_status

E. Performance Requirements

Matching Speed

Generate match recommendations within 5 seconds of profile completion

Message Delivery

Real-time chat with maximum 2-second latency

App Load Time

Launch to home screen within 3 seconds on standard 4G connection

Concurrent Users

Support 5,000 concurrent users in MVP phase

Database Queries

Match algorithm queries execute in less than 2 seconds

Uptime

99.5% availability during peak usage hours (8 AM - 10 PM)

F. Security & Privacy Requirements

- **Data Encryption:** All data encrypted in transit (TLS 1.3) and at rest (AES-256)
- **Authentication:** University SSO only; no third-party social login in MVP
- **Profile Visibility:** Users only visible to other verified students from same university
- **Data Retention:** User data deleted within 30 days of account deletion request
- **FERPA Compliance:** No sharing of student academic records without explicit consent
- **Chat Privacy:** Messages encrypted end-to-end; no message content stored after delivery

G. Scalability Considerations

- **Microservices Architecture:** Separate matching service from chat service for independent scaling
- **Database Sharding:** User data partitioned by university/semester if scaling to multiple institutions
- **Caching Strategy:** Redis cache for frequent match queries (cache invalidation on profile update)
- **CDN:** Static assets and profile photos served via CloudFront CDN

VII. Launch Success Metrics (KPIs)

AARRR Funnel Metrics for MVP

Measuring success across the complete user lifecycle: Acquisition, Activation, Retention, Revenue, and Referral.

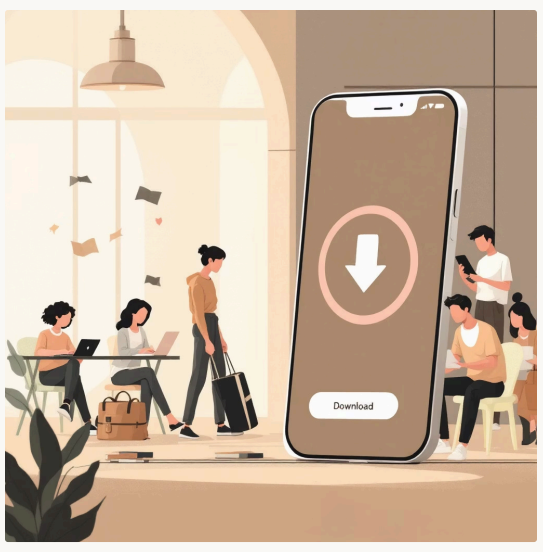
1. Acquisition Metrics

Primary KPI: User Sign-Up Rate

- **Definition:** Number of students who complete university SSO authentication and land on the app
- **Target:** 500 users in first 4 weeks (pilot with 1,500-student cohort = 33% penetration)
- **Measurement:** Track successful SSO authentications via analytics dashboard
- **Data Source:** Backend authentication logs

Secondary Metrics

- **App Download Rate:** Downloads / Marketing impressions
- **Target:** 40% of students who see promotional materials download the app
- **Source Attribution:** UTM parameters in download links from posters, emails, social media



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2. Activation Metrics

Primary KPI: Profile Completion Rate

- **Definition:** Percentage of users who complete the full onboarding flow (SSO → Course selection → Preferences questionnaire → First match view)
- **Target:** 70% of users who sign up complete their profile
- **Measurement:** Track completion of Step 5 in onboarding flow
- **Drop-off Analysis:** Identify which onboarding step has highest abandonment

Secondary Metrics

Time to First Match

Average time from sign-up to viewing first match recommendation

Target: 5 minutes or less for 80% of users

First Match Viewed Rate

Percentage of users who view at least one match card

Target: 85% of users who complete profile view matches within 24 hours

Formula:

$$\text{Activation Rate} = \frac{\text{Users who complete profile and view matches}}{\text{Total sign-ups}} \times 100$$

Target: 70%

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3. Retention Metrics

Primary KPI: Week-1 Retention Rate

- **Definition:** Percentage of activated users who return to the app within 7 days of sign-up
- **Target:** 50% Week-1 retention
- **Measurement:** Track user logins in 7-day window post-activation
- **Cohort Analysis:** Break down by user persona (e.g., freshmen vs. seniors)

Secondary Metrics

- **Active Study Groups Created:** Number of groups that schedule at least one study session
  Target: 40% of formed groups have confirmed meeting within 2 weeks
- **Daily Active Users (DAU):** Unique users who open app per day
  Target: 30% of total user base active daily during mid-semester
- **Connection Retention:** Percentage of accepted connections that exchange 3+ messages
  Target: 60% of connections have ongoing conversations

Formula:

$$\text{Week-1 Retention} = \frac{\text{Users active on Day 7}}{\text{Users activated on Day 0}} \times 100$$

Target: 50%

Churn Indicators to Monitor

- Users who receive 0 match requests in first week (re-engagement campaign needed)
- Users who send requests but receive 0 acceptances (matching algorithm quality issue)

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4. Revenue (Future Metric - Not Applicable to MVP)

Note: MVP is free for all students. Revenue metrics will be tracked in future iterations if freemium model or institutional licensing is introduced.

Potential Future KPI

- **Premium Feature Adoption Rate** (if introduced post-MVP)
- **Institutional Partnership ARR** (annual recurring revenue from universities paying for campus-wide deployment)

For MVP, we track **engagement value** as a proxy:

- **Study Session Attendance Rate:** Percentage of scheduled sessions that actually occur
- **Target:** 70% of scheduled study sessions confirmed by group members
- **Definition:** Success proxy indicating product value delivery

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5. Referral Metrics

Primary KPI: Organic Referral Rate

- **Definition:** Percentage of new users who joined because an existing user invited them or mentioned the app
- **Target:** 25% of new sign-ups from Week 3 onwards are referrals
- **Measurement:** Post-sign-up survey question: "How did you hear about Campus Connect?"
- **Options:** Friend recommendation / Saw someone using it / Poster/Email / Other

Secondary Metrics

- **Viral Coefficient (K-Factor):** Average number of new users each existing user brings
  Target: K-factor of 0.5 by Week 6 (each user brings 0.5 new users on average)
- **Word-of-Mouth Indicator:** Mentions in campus social media groups/channels
  Target: 10+ organic mentions in student WhatsApp/Facebook groups within first month

Formulas:

$$\text{Referral Rate} = \frac{\text{New users from referrals}}{\text{Total new users}} \times 100$$

Target: 25% by Week 3

$$\text{K-Factor} = (\text{Number of invitations sent per user}) \times (\text{Conversion rate of invitations})$$

Target: 0.5+

Referral Triggers (Natural, No Formal Program in MVP)

- User successfully forms study group → likely to tell friends in other courses
- User aces exam after productive study sessions → attributes success to app

Consolidated KPI Dashboard (Weekly Tracking)

Metric	Target	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Status
Acquisition						
Total Sign-Ups	500	80	200	350	500	🟢 On Track
Activation						
Profile Completion Rate	70%	65%	68%	72%	75%	🟢 Exceeds
First Match Viewed	85%	78%	82%	87%	90%	🟢 Exceeds
Retention						
Week-1 Retention	50%	-	48%	52%	55%	🟢 On Track
Active Study Groups	40%	15%	28%	42%	48%	🟢 Exceeds
Referral						
Referral Rate	25%	5%	12%	26%	30%	🟢 Exceeds

Color Coding:

- 🟢 Green: Meeting or exceeding target
- 🟡 Yellow: Within 10% of target (monitor closely)
- 🔴 Red: Below target by >10% (intervention required)

Success Criteria for MVP Launch

The MVP will be deemed successful and ready for broader rollout if:

✅ Acquisition

500+ students sign up within first semester pilot (33% of target cohort)

✅ Activation

70%+ profile completion rate, indicating smooth onboarding

✅ Retention

50%+ Week-1 retention, showing sustained engagement

✅ Value Delivery

40%+ of formed study groups schedule actual sessions, proving matchmaking quality

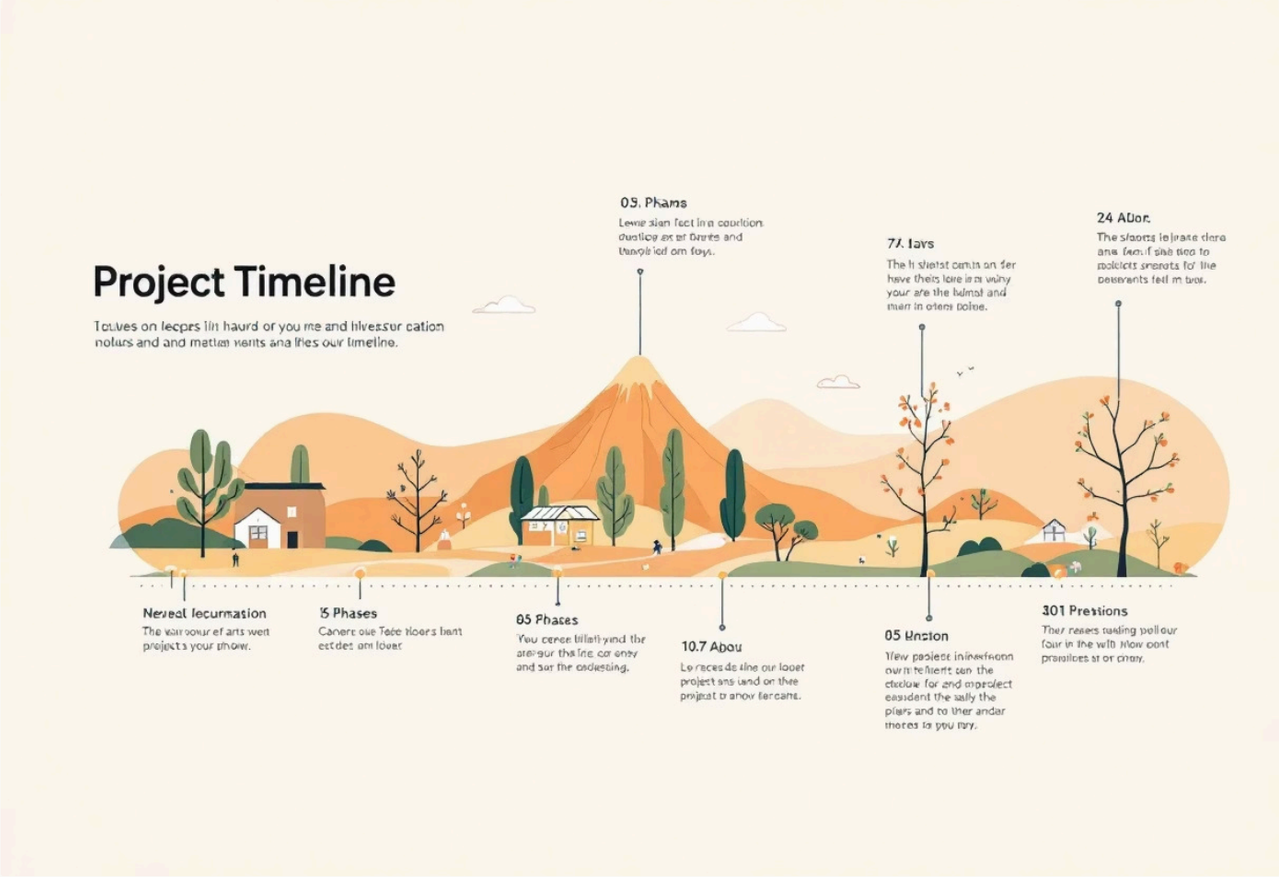
✅ Organic Growth

25%+ referral rate by Week 3, demonstrating product-market fit

If these metrics are achieved, next phase will include:

- Expanding to additional academic departments
- Adding campus events aggregation feature
- Implementing in-app calendar integration
- Exploring institutional partnerships for campus-wide deployment

Appendix: Implementation Timeline



Week 1-2: Backend infrastructure setup, database schema design, university API integration

Week 3-4: AI matching algorithm development and testing

Week 5-6: Mobile app UI/UX design and frontend development

Week 7-8: Real-time chat implementation and integration

Week 9-10: Internal testing, bug fixes, security audit

Week 11: Pilot launch with 100 beta users, gather feedback

Week 12: Iterations based on feedback, prepare for full launch

Week 13+: Official MVP launch and metrics tracking

Document Version Control

Version Details

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Author: Product Management Team

Review Information

Reviewers: Engineering Lead, UX Designer, University Partnership Lead

Next Review: Post-MVP launch (Week 16)